

INDEPENDENCE & PARTITION (1946–1947)

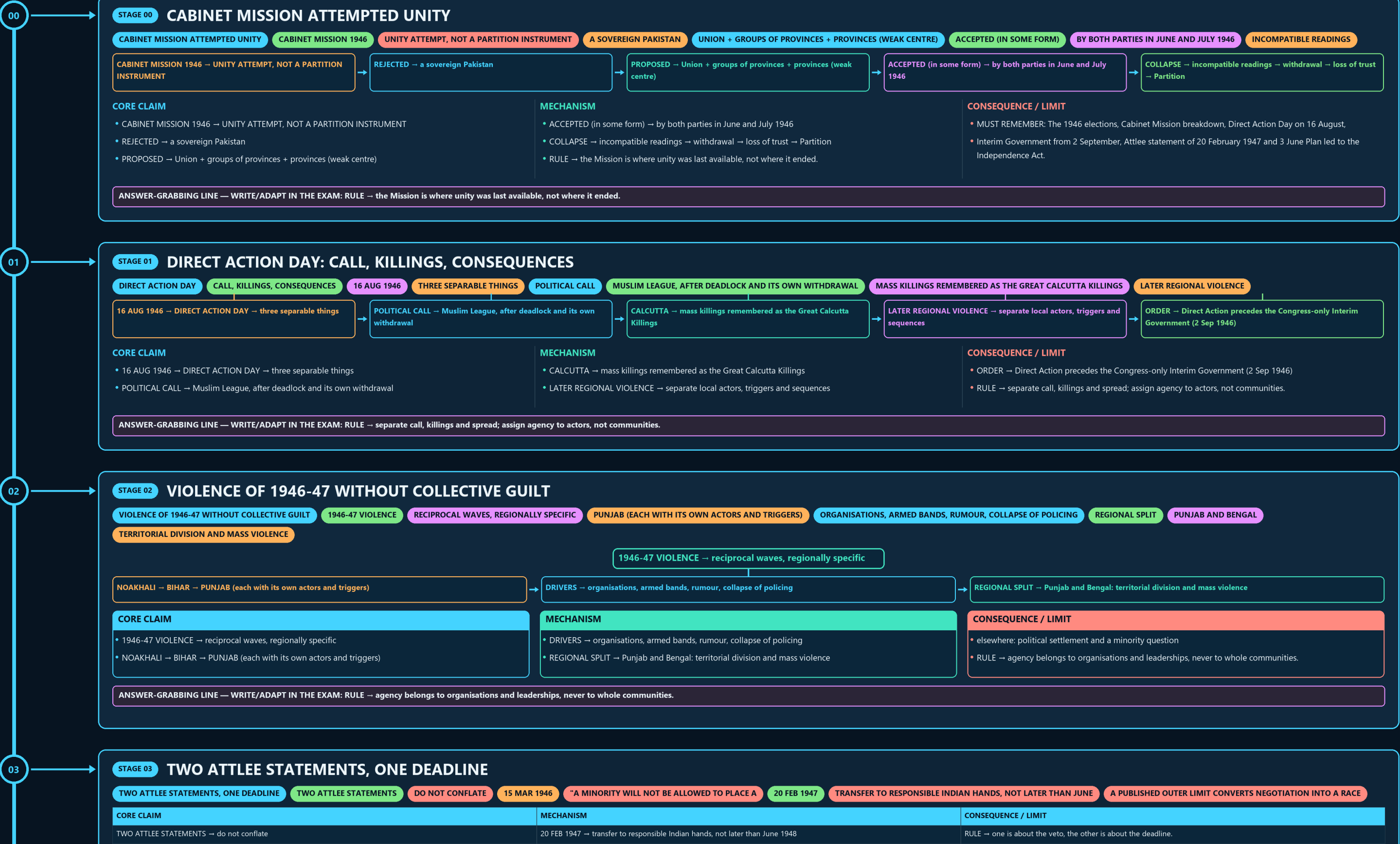
CABINET MISSION ATTEMPTED UNITY → DIRECT ACTION DAY: CALL → VIOLENCE OF 1946-47 WITHOUT → TWO ATTLEE STATEMENTS, ONE → MOUNTBATTEN AND THE ACCELERATED → 3 JUNE PLAN: A

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → agency belongs to organisations and leaderships, never to whole communities.

03

STAGE 03 TWO ATTLEE STATEMENTS, ONE DEADLINE

TWO ATTLEE STATEMENTS, ONE DEADLINE

TWO ATTLEE STATEMENTS

DO NOT CONFLATE

15 MAR 1946

"A MINORITY WILL NOT BE ALLOWED TO PLACE A

20 FEB 1947

TRANSFER TO RESPONSIBLE INDIAN HANDS, NOT LATER THAN JUNE

A PUBLISHED OUTER LIMIT CONVERTS NEGOTIATION INTO A RACE

CORE CLAIM

TWO ATTLEE STATEMENTS → do not conflate

15 MAR 1946 → "a minority will not be allowed to place a veto" → pre-Mission

MECHANISM

20 FEB 1947 → transfer to responsible Indian hands, not later than June 1948

EFFECT → a published outer limit converts negotiation into a race against a date

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

RULE → one is about the veto, the other is about the deadline.

TWO ATTLEE STATEMENTS → do not conflate

CORE CLAIM

• TWO ATTLEE STATEMENTS → do not conflate

• 15 MAR 1946 → "a minority will not be allowed to place a veto" → pre-Mission

MECHANISM

• 20 FEB 1947 → transfer to responsible Indian hands, not later than June 1948

• EFFECT → a published outer limit converts negotiation into a race against a date

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• RULE → one is about the veto, the other is about the deadline.

• TWO ATTLEE STATEMENTS → do not conflate

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → one is about the veto, the other is about the deadline.

04

STAGE 04 MOUNTBATTEN AND THE ACCELERATED TIMETABLE

MOUNTBATTEN AND THE ACCELERATED TIMETABLE

MAR 1947

MOUNTBATTEN ARRIVES AS LAST VICEROY

JUNE 1948 OUTER LIMIT COMPRESSED TO AUGUST 1947

ADMINISTRATIVE, MILITARY AND BOUNDARY ARRANGEMENTS LEFT INCOMPLETE

ANALYTICAL PLACE

EXPLAINS EXECUTION AND DISORDER, NOT THE CHOICE TO PARTITION

HASTE BELONGS IN CONSEQUENCES, NOT IN CAUSES.

MAR 1947 → MOUNTBATTEN ARRIVES AS LAST VICEROY

DEADLINE → June 1948 outer limit compressed to August 1947

CONSEQUENCE → administrative, military and boundary arrangements left incomplete

ANALYTICAL PLACE → explains execution and disorder, not the choice to partition

RULE → haste belongs in consequences, not in causes.

CORE CLAIM

• MAR 1947 → MOUNTBATTEN ARRIVES AS LAST VICEROY

• DEADLINE → June 1948 outer limit compressed to August 1947

MECHANISM

• CONSEQUENCE → administrative, military and boundary arrangements left incomplete

• ANALYTICAL PLACE → explains execution and disorder, not the choice to partition

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• RULE → haste belongs in consequences, not in causes.

• MAR 1947 → MOUNTBATTEN ARRIVES AS LAST VICEROY

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → haste belongs in consequences, not in causes.

05

STAGE 05 3 JUNE PLAN: A POLITICAL PLAN, NOT AN ACT

3 JUNE PLAN

A POLITICAL PLAN, NOT AN ACT

3 JUNE 1947

MOUNTBATTEN PLAN

A POLITICAL PLAN

PARTITION IN PRINCIPLE

PROVIDES FOR

DIVISION OF PUNJAB AND BENGAL

3 JUNE 1947 → MOUNTBATTEN PLAN → a POLITICAL plan

ACCEPTS → Partition in principle

PROVIDES FOR → division of Punjab and Bengal

→ referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet

CORE CLAIM

• 3 JUNE 1947 → MOUNTBATTEN PLAN → a POLITICAL plan

• ACCEPTS → Partition in principle

• PROVIDES FOR → division of Punjab and Bengal

MECHANISM

• → referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet

• → boundary commissions

• LIMIT → not an Act of Parliament; transfers no power by itself

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• RULE → the political decision precedes the legal enactment of July 1947.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → the political decision precedes the legal enactment of July 1947.

06

STAGE 06 THREE PARTITION MECHANISMS

THREE PARTITION MECHANISMS

HOW PARTITION WAS CARRIED OUT

THREE DIFFERENT PROCEDURES

ASSEMBLY VOTES

PUNJAB AND BENGAL, BY THE TWO NOTIONAL HALVES OF

NORTH-WEST FRONTIER PROVINCE AND SYLHET DISTRICT OF ASSAM

→ BOTH RESULTS TOOK THEM INTO PAKISTAN

BOUNDARY COMMISSIONS

CORE CLAIM

HOW PARTITION WAS CARRIED OUT → three different procedures

ASSEMBLY VOTES → Punjab and Bengal, by the two notional halves of each assembly

MECHANISM

REFERENDUMS → North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet district of Assam

→ both results took them into Pakistan

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

BOUNDARY COMMISSIONS → technical line-drawing, separate from both routes

RULE → match the province to its mechanism; never swap them.

CORE CLAIM

• HOW PARTITION WAS CARRIED OUT → three different procedures

MECHANISM

• REFERENDUMS → North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet district of Assam

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• BOUNDARY COMMISSIONS → technical line-drawing, separate from both routes

06

STAGE 06

THREE PARTITION MECHANISMS

THREE PARTITION MECHANISMSHOW PARTITION WAS CARRIED OUTTHREE DIFFERENT PROCEDURESASSEMBLY VOTESPUNJAB AND BENGAL, BY THE TWO NOTIONAL HALVES OFNORTH-WEST FRONTIER PROVINCE AND SYLHET DISTRICT OF ASSAM→ BOTH RESULTS TOOK THEM INTO PAKISTAN

BOUNDARY COMMISSIONS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
HOW PARTITION WAS CARRIED OUT → three different procedures	REFERENDUMS → North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet district of Assam	BOUNDARY COMMISSIONS → technical line-drawing, separate from both routes
ASSEMBLY VOTES → Punjab and Bengal, by the two notional halves of each assembly	→ both results took them into Pakistan	RULE → match the province to its mechanism; never swap them.

CORE CLAIM

- HOW PARTITION WAS CARRIED OUT → three different procedures
- ASSEMBLY VOTES → Punjab and Bengal, by the two notional halves of each assembly

MECHANISM

- REFERENDUMS → North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet district of Assam
- → both results took them into Pakistan

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- BOUNDARY COMMISSIONS → technical line-drawing, separate from both routes
- RULE → match the province to its mechanism; never swap them.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → match the province to its mechanism; never swap them.

07

STAGE 07

INDIAN INDEPENDENCE ACT: ASSENT AND COMMENCEMENT

INDIAN INDEPENDENCE ACTASSENT AND COMMENCEMENTTHE LEGAL ENACTMENTROYAL ASSENT18 JULY 1947 (WESTMINSTER)TWO DOMINIONS, INDIA AND PAKISTAN, FROM 15 AUGUST 1947ALSO PROVIDESLAPSE OF BRITISH PARAMOUNTCY OVER THE PRINCELY STATES

INDIAN INDEPENDENCE ACT → the LEGAL enactment

ROYAL ASSENT → 18 July 1947 (Westminster)

COMMENCEMENT → two dominions, India and Pakistan, from 15 August 1947

ALSO PROVIDES → lapse of British paramountcy over the princely states

SEQUENCE → 3 June political plan → 18 July assent → 15 August commencement

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
INDIAN INDEPENDENCE ACT → the LEGAL enactment	COMMENCEMENT → two dominions, India and Pakistan, from 15 August 1947	SEQUENCE → 3 June political plan → 18 July assent → 15 August commencement
ROYAL ASSENT → 18 July 1947 (Westminster)	ALSO PROVIDES → lapse of British paramountcy over the princely states	RULE → assent and commencement are separate legal events.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → assent and commencement are separate legal events.

08

STAGE 08

STATUTORY COMMENCEMENT VERSUS COMMEMORATIVE OBSERVANCE

STATUTORY COMMENCEMENT VERSUS COMMEMORATIVE OBSERVANCEWHAT THE STATUTE SAYSWHAT COMMEMORATION SAYS BOTH DOMINIONS CREATEDPAKISTAN OBSERVES 14 AUGUST AS ITS NATIONAL DAY FROMCEREMONIES AT KARACHI (14TH) AND DELHI (15TH)

STATUTORY COMMENCEMENT IS ONE DATE; COMMEMORATIVE OBSERVANCE IS ANOTHER.

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
WHAT THE STATUTE SAYS	Pakistan observes 14 August as its national day from 15 August 1947	RULE → statutory commencement is one date; commemorative observance is another.
WHAT COMMEMORATION SAYS both dominions created	ceremonies at Karachi (14th) and Delhi (15th)	WHAT THE STATUTE SAYS

CORE CLAIM

- WHAT THE STATUTE SAYS
- WHAT COMMEMORATION SAYS both dominions created

MECHANISM

- Pakistan observes 14 August as its national day from 15 August 1947
- ceremonies at Karachi (14th) and Delhi (15th)

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- RULE → statutory commencement is one date; commemorative observance is another.
- WHAT THE STATUTE SAYS

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → statutory commencement is one date; commemorative observance is another.

09

STAGE 09

THE LAPSE OF PARAMOUNTCY

THE LAPSE OF PARAMOUNTCYLAPSED (IT DID NOT TRANSFER)NOT INHERITEDNEITHER DOMINION SUCCEEDED TO SUZERAINTY AUTOMATICALLYEACH STATE'S RELATIONSHIP HAD TO BE CREATED AFRESHACCESSION OR AGREEMENT, NEGOTIATED STATE BY STATE

"LAPSED" IS THE OPERATIVE VERB; "TRANSFERRED" IS THE ERROR.CLOSE DISTINCTION

PARAMOUNTCY → LAPSED (it did not transfer)

NOT INHERITED → neither dominion succeeded to suzerainty automatically

CONSEQUENCE → each state's relationship had to be created afresh

ROUTE → accession or agreement, negotiated state by state

RULE → "lapsed" is the operative verb; "transferred" is the error.

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
PARAMOUNTCY → LAPSED (it did not transfer)	ROUTE → accession or agreement, negotiated state by state	transfer dates, Radcliffe Award publication and mass displacement must remain separately dated.
NOT INHERITED → neither dominion succeeded to suzerainty automatically	RULE → "lapsed" is the operative verb; "transferred" is the error.	
CONSEQUENCE → each state's relationship had to be created afresh	CLOSE DISTINCTION: The Indian Independence Act received royal assent on 18 July 1947	

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → "lapsed" is the operative verb; "transferred" is the error.

INDEPENDENCE & PARTITION (1946–1947) • TILE 3/4 • same master rows 5440–8674 of 11394 • continues below

CORE CLAIM

- PARAMOUNTCY → LAPSED (it did not transfer)
- NOT INHERITED → neither dominion succeeded to suzerainty automatically
- CONSEQUENCE → each state's relationship had to be created afresh

MECHANISM

- ROUTE → accession or agreement, negotiated state by state
- RULE → "lapsed" is the operative verb; "transferred" is the error.
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: The Indian Independence Act received royal assent on 18 July 1947

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- transfer dates, Radcliffe Award publication and mass displacement must remain separately dated.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → "lapsed" is the operative verb; "transferred" is the error.

10

STAGE 10

RADCLIFFE: TWO COMMISSIONS, AWARDS OF 17 AUGUST

TWO COMMISSIONS, AWARDS OF 17 AUGUST

BOUNDARY MECHANISM

TWO COMMISSIONS, ONE CHAIRMAN

PUNJAB COMMISSION

BENGAL COMMISSION

CHAired BY CYRIL RADCLIFFE

EQUAL CONGRESS-NOMINATED AND LEAGUE-NOMINATED JUDGES

MEMBERS DIVIDE

BOUNDARY MECHANISM → two commissions, one chairman

PUNJAB COMMISSION

BENGAL COMMISSION → chaired by Cyril Radcliffe

COMPOSITION → equal Congress-nominated and League-nominated judges

DEADLOCK → members divide → decisions fall to the chairman

CORE CLAIM

- BOUNDARY MECHANISM → two commissions, one chairman
- PUNJAB COMMISSION
- BENGAL COMMISSION → chaired by Cyril Radcliffe
- COMPOSITION → equal Congress-nominated and League-nominated judges

MECHANISM

- DEADLOCK → members divide → decisions fall to the chairman
- 15 AUG 1947 → transfer of power
- 17 AUG 1947 → awards published
- CONSEQUENCE → border districts uncertain; violence already under way before the line.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Partition requires League, Congress, British, provincial and popular agency plus gendered violence and refugee evidence
- communal inevitability and single-person blame are both inadequate.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — CONSEQUENCE → border districts uncertain; violence already under way before the line.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: Partition requires League, Congress, British, provincial and popular agency plus gendered violence and refugee evidence; communal inevitability and single-person blame are both inadequate.

11

STAGE 11

RESPONSIBILITY, CONTINGENCY AND THE THREE REGISTERS

RESPONSIBILITY, CONTINGENCY AND THE THREE REGISTERS

CONGRESS ACCEPTANCE

RELUCTANT AND PRAGMATIC; DEADLOCK, VIOLENCE, GOVERNABILITY

STRUCTURE (1909 ONWARDS) + CONTINGENCY (DATED 1946-47 DECISIONS)

BRITISH POLICY

MUSLIM LEAGUE

COMMUNAL ORGANISATIONS

MASS FEAR AND REGIONAL DYNAMICS; NO SINGLE VILLAIN

CONGRESS ACCEPTANCE → reluctant and pragmatic; deadlock, violence, governability

INEVITABILITY → structure (1909 onwards) + contingency (dated 1946-47 decisions)

RESPONSIBILITY → British policy

Muslim League

communal organisations

CORE CLAIM

- CONGRESS ACCEPTANCE → reluctant and pragmatic; deadlock, violence, governability
- INEVITABILITY → structure (1909 onwards) + contingency (dated 1946-47 decisions)
- RESPONSIBILITY → British policy
- Muslim League

MECHANISM

- communal organisations
- mass fear and regional dynamics; no single villain
- THREE REGISTERS → legal transfer
- political triumph

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- humanitarian catastrophe
- HUMAN COST → displacement around 10 to 15 million (broad estimate); deaths contested
- GANDHI → in Calcutta and Bengal for communal peace, not celebrating in Delhi
- RULE → record all three registers; a one-sided verdict answers only part.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → record all three registers; a one-sided verdict answers only part.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

INDIA'S STRUGGLE FOR INDEPENDENCE TREATS PARTITION AS THE TRAGIC

COMMUNALISATION PROCESS INTENSIFIED BY COLONIAL POLICY, LEAGUE SEPARATISM AND

THE CABINET MISSION SCHEME FAILED BECAUSE CONGRESS VIEWED INDIA

WHILE THE LEAGUE SAW COMPULSORY GROUPING AS THE MINIMUM

DIRECT ACTION DAY AND SUBSEQUENT VIOLENCE CONVERTED ELITE CONSTITUTIONAL

PARTITION CANNOT BE EXPLAINED BY ONE VILLAIN ALONE

IT REQUIRES ANALYSIS OF BRITISH HASTE, LEAGUE INTRANSIGENCE, CONGRESS'S

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- India's Struggle for Independence treats Partition as the tragic end of a long
- communalisation process intensified by colonial policy, League separatism and the crisis of transfer.
- The Cabinet Mission scheme failed because Congress viewed India as one sovereign nation-making unit,
- while the League saw compulsory grouping as the minimum safeguard for Muslim-majority zones.

ADVANCED DEBATE

- Direct Action Day and subsequent violence converted elite constitutional disagreement into mass fear and retaliatory communal mobilisation.
- CAUTION: Partition cannot be explained by one villain alone
- it requires analysis of British haste, League intransigence, Congress's acceptance, and the accumulated growth of communal ideology.
- Congress leaders accepted Partition reluctantly because they feared a weak centre, continuing

LEGACY / NUANCE

- communal paralysis and prolonged violence if the Cabinet Mission framework survived unreconciled.
- The 3 June Plan operationalised partition through legislative votes, referendums and boundary commissions.
- The Indian Independence Act created two dominions and allowed princely paramountcy to lapse, creating the next nation-building challenge.
- CAUTION: The human tragedy of Partition lay in the gap between high-political decisions

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.